

Maryland AI Community of Practice (MDAI)

05/01/2026

Agenda

1. **Welcome and Introduction to the AI CoP** (Lauren Maffeo, DoIT)
2. **A Crash Course in NotebookLM** (Hunter Anderson and Blake Cook, Google)
3. **What's Next** (Lauren Maffeo, DoIT)



CoP Etiquette

- Mics on Mute to prevent background noise
- Only the speaker should have their camera on to avoid visual distractions
- Add your questions to the Comments or Q&A section of our chat
- The AI Enablement Team will try and address questions in the chat async
- Forward this meeting to peers who might benefit (<https://meet.google.com/cbi-iazh-ccn>)
- Bring an owner's mindset & participate!



MDAI's Vision & Values

Maryland's Vision for AI

The State of Maryland responsibly, ethically, and productively leverages AI/ML technologies to significantly improve constituent outcomes and reduce drudgery for the State workforce.

MDAI's Values

1) Collaborate Across Teams

- Meet regularly to share AI use cases, wins, struggles, questions, and best practices.
- Provide shared space for anyone in Maryland to learn how they can harness AI.
- Connect with peers who have the same issues or aspects of AI enablement as you do.

MDAI's Values

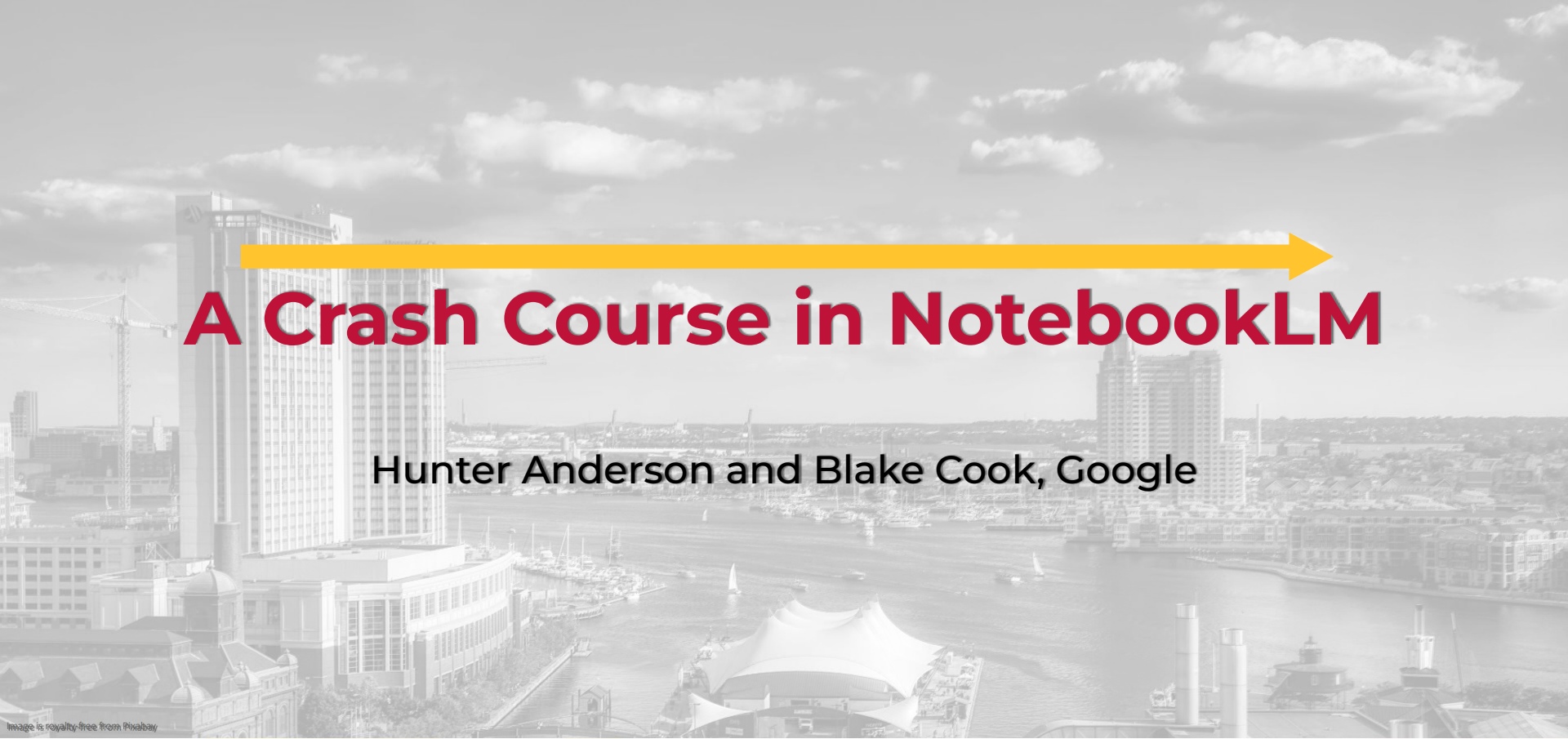
2) Show, Don't Tell

- Host lunch n' learns to show how Maryland's civil servants can use enterprise AI tools.
- Share AI proofs of concept to demo how your peers use AI.
- Highlight guest speakers beyond government to share new AI innovations.

MDAI's Values

3) Provide AI Updates in a Shared Space

- Share new AI policies, processes, guidance, etc. for state employees to use.
- Offer blueprints for anyone serving Maryland (city, county, state, etc.) to leverage AI.
- Provide Maryland's AIE team as a foundational source for where to start with AI.



A Crash Course in NotebookLM

Hunter Anderson and Blake Cook, Google

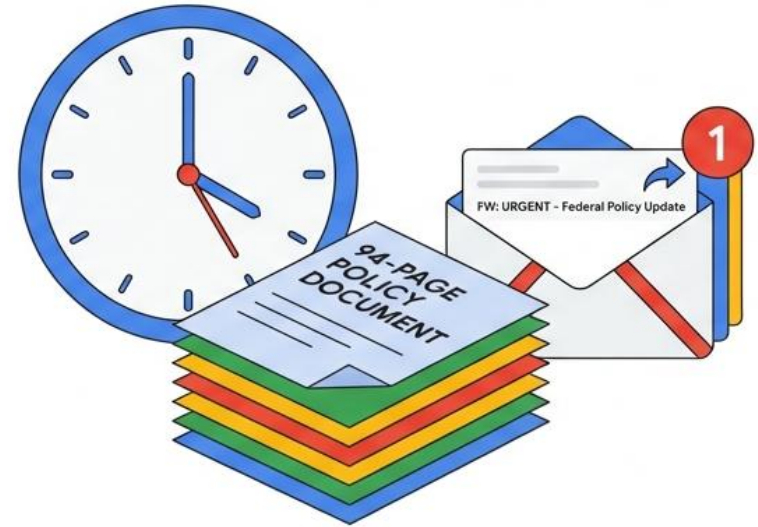
In this module, you'll:

- ✓ What NotebookLM is and how it differs from Gemini
- ✓ Interrogate complex documents with targeted questions
- ✓ Generate Audio Overviews for your commute

It's 4:47 PM on Friday.

Your director just forwarded a 94-page federal policy document.

"I need a summary and our exposure by Monday morning."



We've All Been There

- Print it out, grab a highlighter
- 3-4 hours of careful reading (if you're fast)
- Scribble notes in the margins
- Hope you didn't miss something critical on page 73
- Write the summary from memory + sticky notes
- Sunday night: "Did I cover everything?"



What If You Had a Research Assistant Who Never Missed a Detail?

NotebookLM is Google's AI research tool — purpose-built for deep document analysis.

Unlike Gemini chat, every answer is grounded in YOUR sources.

No hallucinations. Every claim links back to the exact passage.



What is NotebookLM?

- A product designed to bring Google's best language models together with your existing information to go from information to insights, faster
- One of the biggest challenges is synthesizing facts and ideas from multiple sources
- Notebook LM uses established documents that you know are valid – and so there is lesser chance to hallucinate
- Brings multimodality to your text-based sources
- Note: NotebookLM Plus is not part of Google Workspace with Gemini, but forms part of the Gemini ecosystem.



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Key benefits of NotebookLM

Keeps your data private and secure

The data you enter into NotebookLM Plus is not human reviewed or used to train AI models

Grounded in information you trust

NotebookLM Plus grounds itself in your enterprise data sources, with in-line citations for accuracy, transparency and trust

From information to insights in a snap

Materials become more approachable with NotebookLM Plus' powerful summarization features

Multimodal and Multilingual

Experience AI research across many modalities - text, graphs, images, and audio - and in many languages

NotebookLM vs. Gemini Chat

GEMINI CHAT



- General-purpose, training data
- Can hallucinate
- No citations
- Context resets

NOTEBOOKLM



- Purpose-built, YOUR sources only
- Cites exact passages
- Zero hallucination
- Persistent

Why This Matters for Government

Government work runs on documents: Federal guidance, legislative bills, contract specs, compliance frameworks, audit reports, policy memos.

The Document-Driven Reality

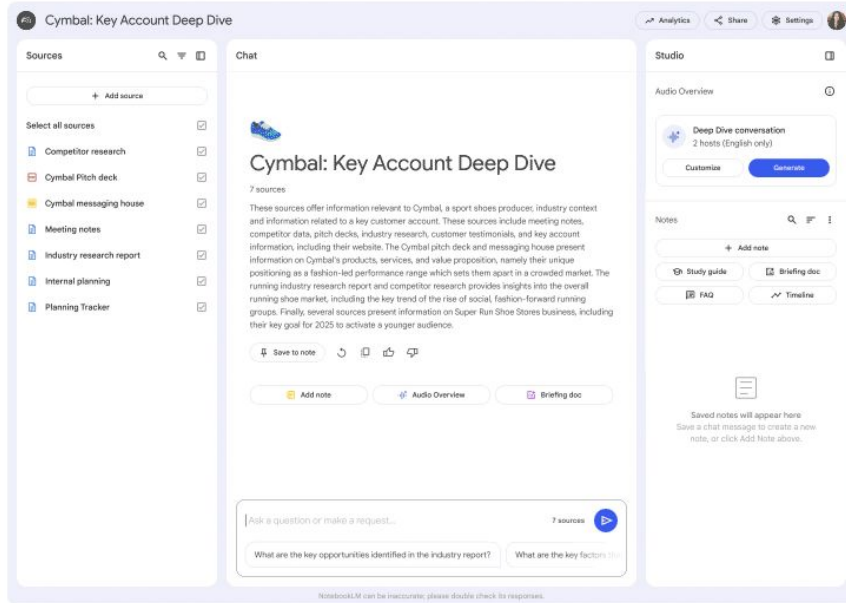
You cannot afford hallucinations.

- Federal guidance
- Legislative bills
- Contract specs
- Compliance frameworks
- Audit reports
- Policy memos



You cannot afford hallucinations. You need traceable answers.

How it works



Upload



Chat



Create

Accessing NotebookLM

In browser:
[Google NotebookLM](https://notebooklm.google.com) or
type in
notebooklm.google.com
for quick access

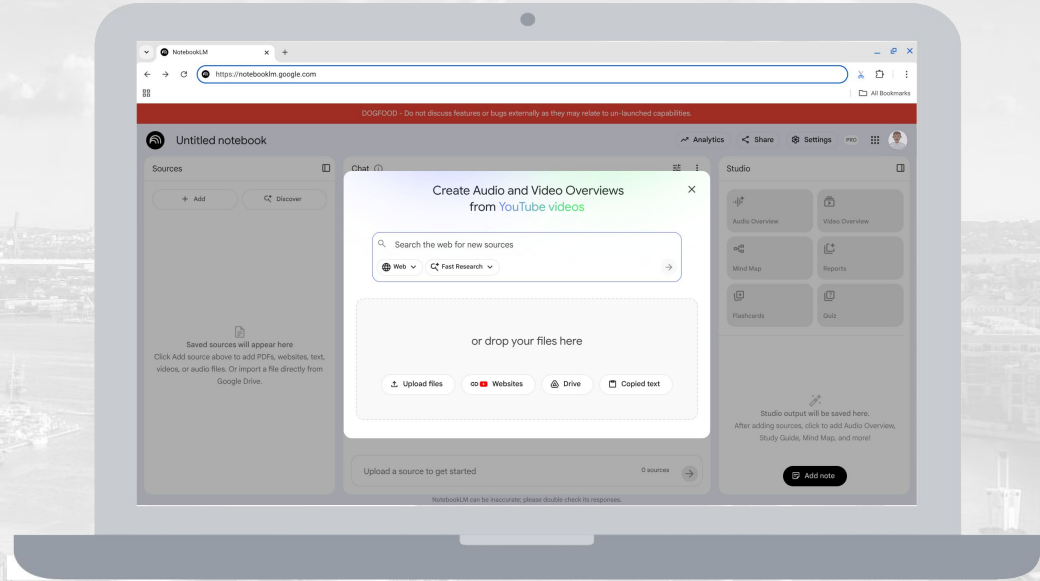


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Create a knowledge hub



Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Scenario: Build a product briefing



Marketing manager

Create a hub for your
product briefing research

Create a knowledge hub (1/5)

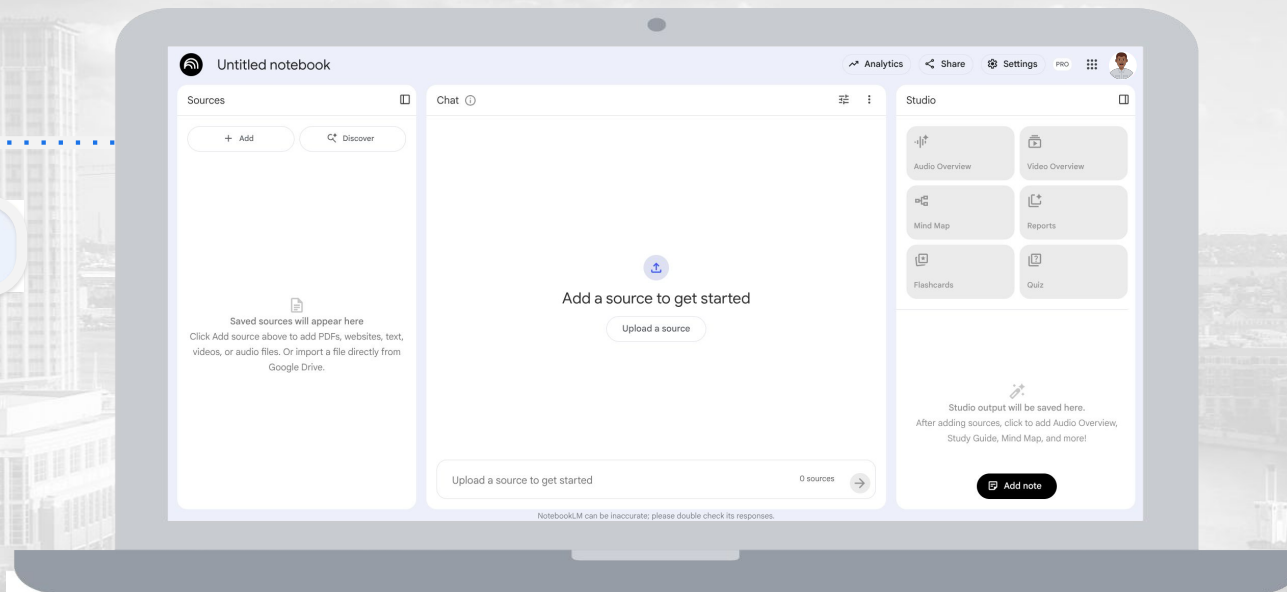
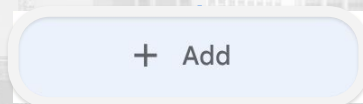


Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Create a knowledge hub (2/5)

Create Audio and Video Overviews from **your documents**

Search the web for new sources

Web

Fast Research

or drop your files here

Upload files

Websites

Drive

Copied text

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Create a knowledge hub (3/5)

B2B SaaS Trends and Customer Needs for 2025

Sources

+ Add Discover

Select all sources ☒

- 2025 B2B SaaS Industry Trend Report- ... ☒
- Comprehensive Competitive Analysis R... ☒
- Q2 2025 Customer Persona Study & Cor... ☒

Chat

B2B SaaS Trends and Customer Needs for 2025

3 sources

These documents collectively provide a strategic framework for a business operating in the B2B SaaS sector. The first source, an **Industry Trend Report for 2025**, focuses on the pivotal importance of **AI integration and workflow automation**, detailing how these technologies will drive product development, hyper-personalization, and operational efficiency, alongside discussing associated challenges and opportunities. The second document is a **Comprehensive Competitive Analysis Report** for "Project A," which benchmarks the company against competitors (Alpha, Beta, Gamma) by examining their features, pricing, and messaging to inform **SWOT analysis and strategic recommendations**. Finally, the third source outlines a **Q2 2025 Customer Persona Study and Core Needs Validation**, detailing the methodology for using quantitative and qualitative research to **define customer segments**, prioritize their needs, and provide actionable insights for product and marketing teams. Together, the sources emphasize external market awareness, competitive positioning, and deep customer understanding to prepare for future technological shifts.

Start typing... 3 sources →

How should the core product strategy respond to competitive weaknesses and verified customer needs? What are the most significant opportunities and challenges presented by AI and workflow automation?

NotebookLM can be inaccurate; please double check its responses.

Create a knowledge hub (4/5)

Discover sources ×



What are you interested in?

latest market trends

Find sources from:

☒ Web

☐ Google Drive

 I'm feeling curious

Submit

← Discover sources ×

These sources provide a macro-level view of 2025 market trends across four critical areas: global economic forecasts shaped by trade tariffs, key technology adoption, shifts in consumer spending, and investment strategies in real estate and commodities.

Select all sources ☐

 Global Economic Prospects -- June 2025 - The World Bank ☒
World Bank's June 2025 global economic and inflation forecast.

 A solid growth outlook for 2025 - Goldman Sachs ☐
Goldman Sachs' 2025 macro outlook, focusing on GDP and trade uncertainty.

 Market Know-How Q4 2025 - Goldman Sachs Asset Management ☒
Q4 2025 investment strategies for institutional use, including tariff impact.

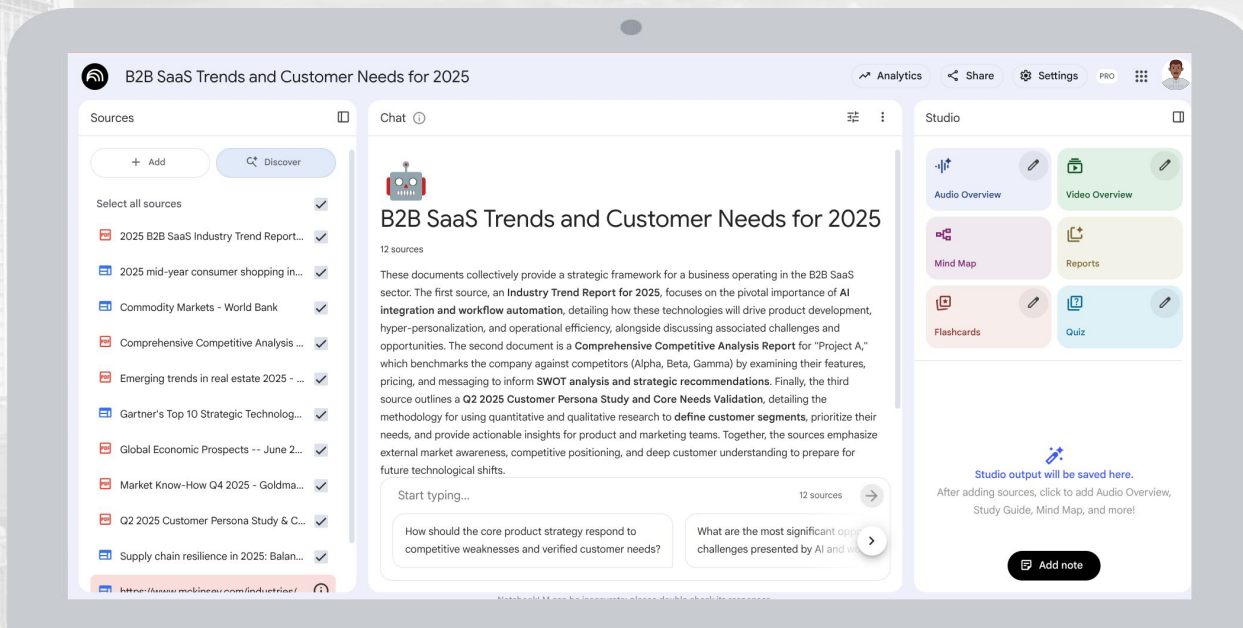
9 sources selected

Import

Submit

Import

Create a knowledge hub (5/5)

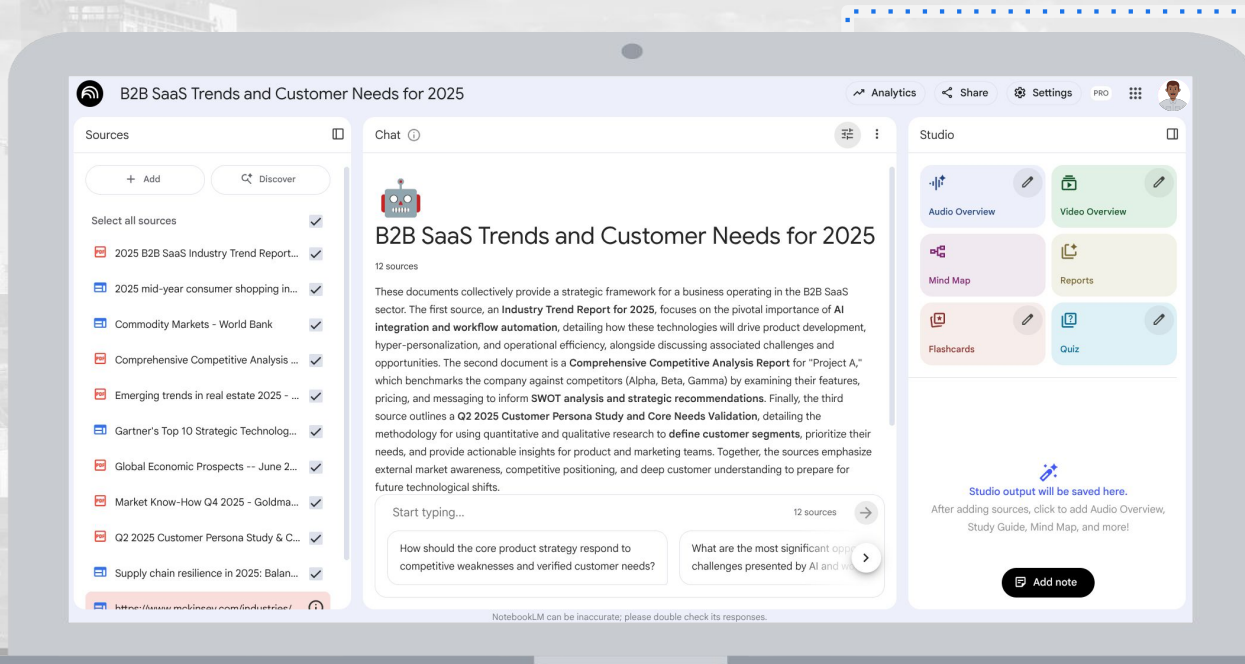


Use the advanced chat settings



Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Use the advanced chat and audio settings (1/4)



Use the advanced chat and audio settings (2/4)

Configure Chat

×

Notebooks can be customized to work as a virtual research assistant, a personal tutor, a shared knowledge-base/help center, and more.

Define your conversational style

✓ Default

Learning Guide

Custom

Best for general purpose research and brainstorming tasks.

Choose your response length

✓ Default

Longer

Shorter

Save

✓ Custom

Examples:

- * Customize the style ("respond at a PhD student level")
- * Suggest different roles ("pretend to be a role-playing game host")

Use the advanced chat and audio settings (3/4)

The screenshot displays a web application interface titled "B2B SaaS Trends and Customer Needs for 2025". The interface is divided into three main sections: Sources, Chat, and Studio.

Sources Panel: Features a list of sources under the heading "Select all sources". The sources include:

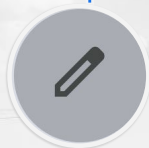
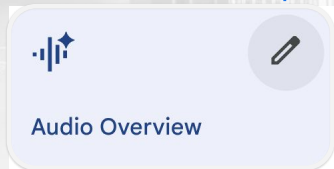
- 2025 B2B SaaS Industry Trend Report...
- 2025 mid-year consumer shopping in...
- Commodity Markets - World Bank
- Comprehensive Competitive Analysis ...
- Emerging trends in real estate 2025 - ...
- Gartner's Top 10 Strategic Technolog...
- Global Economic Prospects -- June 2...
- Market Know-How Q4 2025 - Goldma...
- Q2 2025 Customer Persona Study & C...
- Supply chain resilience in 2025: Balan...

Chat Panel: Displays the title "B2B SaaS Trends and Customer Needs for 2025" and "12 sources". The chat content includes a paragraph about a strategic framework for a business operating in the B2B SaaS sector, focusing on AI integration and workflow automation. It mentions a "Comprehensive Competitive Analysis Report for 'Project A,'" which benchmarks the company against competitors (Alpha, Beta, Gamma) by examining their features, pricing, and messaging to inform SWOT analysis and strategic recommendations. The third source outlines a "Q2 2025 Customer Persona Study and Core Needs Validation," detailing the methodology for using quantitative and qualitative research to define customer segments, prioritize their needs, and provide actionable insights for product and marketing teams. Together, the sources emphasize external market awareness, competitive positioning, and deep customer understanding to prepare for future technological shifts.

Studio Panel: Contains a grid of interactive elements: Audio Overview, Video Overview, Mind Map, Reports, Flashcards, and Quiz. A note states: "Studio output will be saved here. After adding sources, click to add Audio Overview, Study Guide, Mind Map, and more!" with an "Add note" button.

A dashed blue box highlights the "Audio Overview" button in the Studio panel and a corresponding "Audio Overview" button in a separate panel on the right.

Use the advanced chat and audio settings (4/4)



 Customize Audio Overview ×

Format

Deep Dive ✓

A lively conversation between two hosts, unpacking and connecting topics in your sources

Brief

A bite-sized overview to help you grasp the core ideas from your sources quickly

Critique

An expert review of your sources, offering constructive feedback to help you improve your material

Debate

A thoughtful debate between two hosts, illuminating different perspectives on your sources

Choose language

English ▼

Length

Shorter

✓ Default

Longer

What should the AI hosts focus on in this episode?

Things to try

- Focus on a specific source ("only cover the article about Italy")
- Focus on a specific topic ("just discuss the novel's main character")
- Target a specific audience ("explain to someone new to biology")

Generate

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The Citation System

Every response includes
numbered citations [1], [2], [3]...

Click any citation → highlights
exact source passage.

“AI said so” vs “Page 47,
paragraph 3 says so.”

• **The Office:** This generally refers to the broader physical location, building, or dedicated room where an organization operates or where an employee goes to work. Sources describe the "office" as a strategic hub essential for collaboration, mentoring, culture building, and career advancement ¹ [>] [<] ² ³ . It is often associated with corporate mandates, such as requirements to be present for a set number of days ⁴ .

• **The Workspace:** This is the immediate, functional area where work tasks are performed. It is often a subset of the office.

◦ **In a corporate setting:** A workspace can be a flexible station (hot desking), a specific desk, or a quiet zone within an open-plan office ⁵ ⁶ .

◦ **In a home setting:** While a "home office" implies a dedicated room, a "workspace" can be carved out of smaller areas, such as a dining table, a hallway corner, or even inside a closet ⁷ ...

◦ **Ergonomics:** The workspace is the focus of ergonomic adjustments, such as the height of the monitor, keyboard placement, and chair comfort, to ensure optimal performance ¹⁰ ¹¹ .

2. Digital Software

• **Office:** In the training logs, "Office" refers to **Microsoft Office** (Word, Excel, Outlook). Users frequently ask about the transition away from "Microsoft Office" and the loss of specific features like Outlook folders and offline file access ¹² ...

• **Workspace:** This refers to **Google Workspace** (formerly G Suite), the cloud-based suite of apps including

Power Questions



COMPLIANCE:
Top 5 compliance
risks for a
municipal agency.



DEADLINES:
Extract all
deadlines
chronologically.



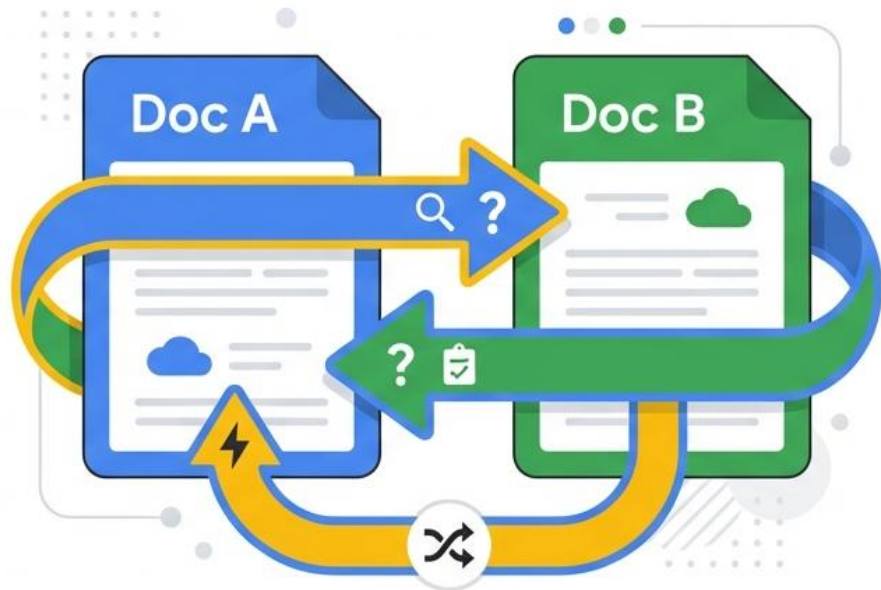
ACTIONS:
What must we do
within 90 days?



The 'Compared To' Technique

Upload MULTIPLE documents, then ask:

- 'How does 2025 differ from 2023?'
- 'Requirements in Doc A not addressed by Doc B?'
- 'Conflicts between these frameworks?'





Real-World: Contract Review

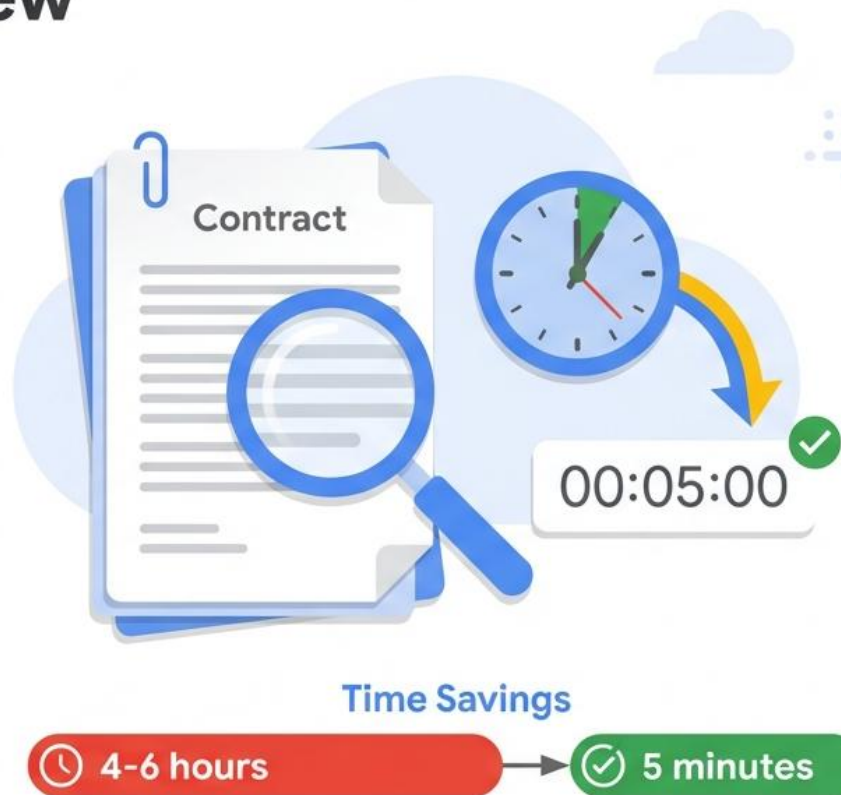
200-page IT modernization contract.

Key questions:

- Penalty clauses?
- Data security requirements?
- Our obligations vs vendor obligations?

Manually: 4-6 hours

NotebookLM: 5 minutes



Real-World: Legislative Analysis

New state bill arrives.

Key questions:

- Reporting requirements?
- Impact on agencies with <500 employees?
- Plain-language summary?
- Fiscal impact?

Every answer traces back to the bill text.



NotebookLM Plus features



Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

NotebookLM Plus features



Scale and capacity

Shared knowledge hub

Faster projects

NotebookLM Plus features

Chat-only

Chat with AI

No access to documents



Full Notebook

Full collaboration

Full access to documents



Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

NotebookLM Plus features

Active users



Daily queries



Measure adoption



Identify knowledge gaps



Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Audio Overviews: The Commute Hack



What Are Audio Overviews?

- ~10 min AI-hosted podcast about YOUR documents.



Customize Audio Overview

Format

Deep Dive ✓
A lively conversation between two hosts, unpacking and connecting topics in your sources

Brief
A bite-sized overview to help you grasp the core ideas from your sources quickly

Critique
An expert review of your sources, offering constructive feedback to help you improve your material

Debate
A thoughtful debate between two hosts, illuminating different perspectives on your sources

Choose language

English

Length

Short

✓ Default

Long

What should the AI hosts focus on in this episode?

Things to try

- Focus on a specific source ("only cover the article about Italy")

Why Audio Overviews Matter



Commute-friendly



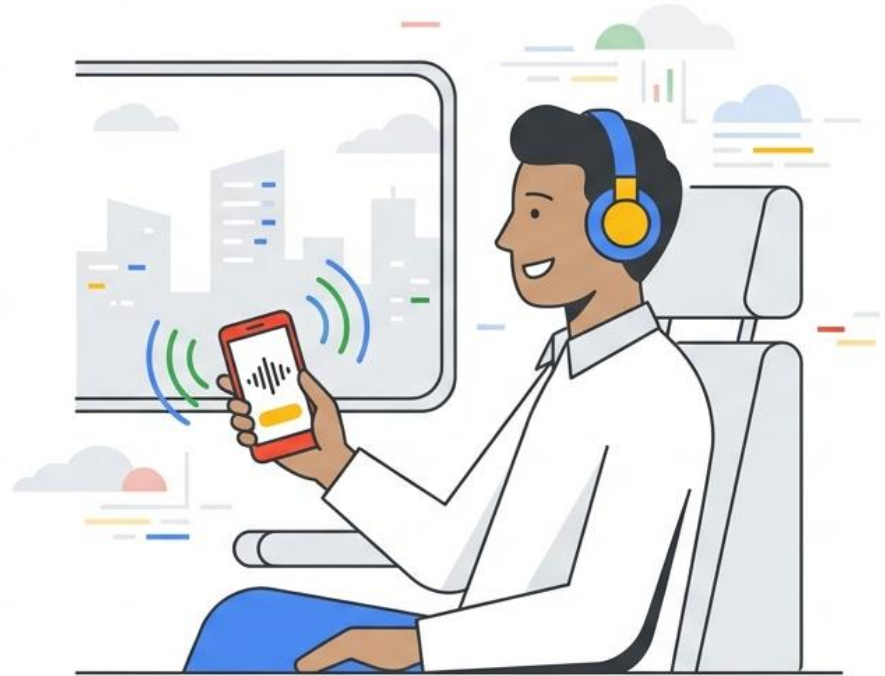
100 pages → 10 minutes



Share with non-readers



Perfect briefing tool



Customizing Audio

Guide the discussion:

- ‘Focus on compliance.’
- ‘Explain for beginners.’
- ‘Emphasize budget implications.’

English ▼

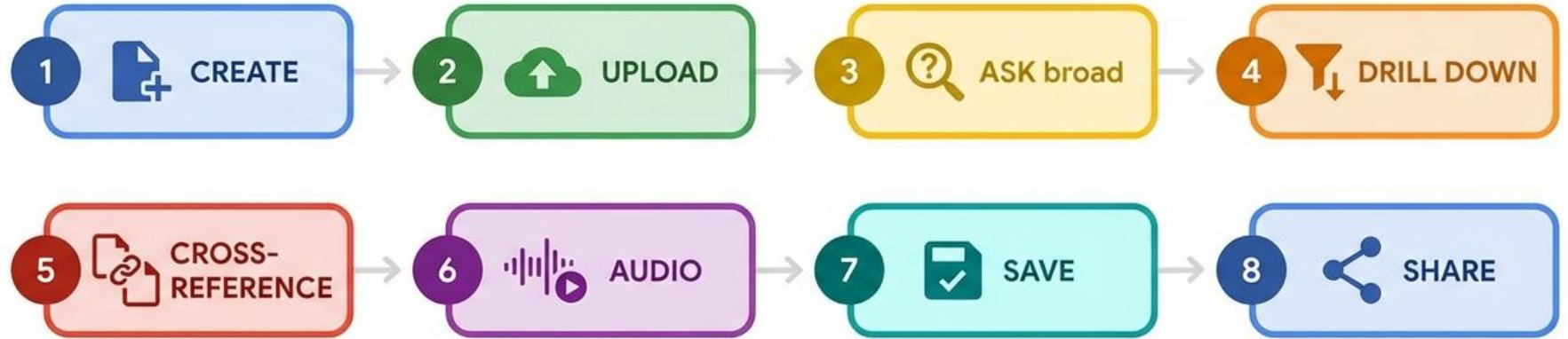
Short ✓ D

What should the AI hosts focus on in this episode?

Things to try

- Focus on a specific source (“only cover the article about Italy”)
- Focus on a specific topic (“just discuss the novel’s main character”)
- Target a specific audience (“explain to someone new to biology”)

Complete Workflow



15-20 minutes vs days.

Tips & Best Practices

- ✓ Upload complete documents
- ✓ Ask specific questions
- ✓ Click citations to verify
- ✓ Use multiple sources
- ✓ Save findings as Notes

- ✗ No classified documents
- ✗ Don't skip verification
- ✗ Don't replace human judgment



Back to Our Scenario

5:15 PM Friday.

28 minutes later:

- Policy uploaded
- Risks identified
- Deadlines extracted
- Summary generated
- Audio briefing created
- Findings saved



“Here’s your briefing, Director.”

Try It Now

-  1. Go to notebooklm.google.com
-  2. Create new notebook
-  3. Upload a document
-  4. Ask 3 questions
-  5. Verify citations
-  6. Generate Audio Overview

10 minutes invested. Hours saved.





What's Next?

- We meet each 1st Friday per month
- Forward this invite to colleagues who might be interested in joining
- [Submit your AI use cases](#) to our inventory
- [Book MDAI Office Hours](#)
- Email AI@Maryland.gov to show your team's AI work at a future CoP!